

GRACE EPISCOPAL CHURCH

72 Pine Street, Portland, Maine 04101
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THANKSGIVING FOOD DRIVE 2026

Nourishing Our Neighbors
A Community Appeal from the Grace Episcopal Outreach Committee

Dear friends and neighbors,

Every November, Grace Episcopal Church gathers food for Portland families who are stretching their budgets, for homebound elders who cannot easily shop, and for our neighbors who find the holiday season one of the hardest months of the year.

This year we are asking our congregation and the wider Munjoy Hill community to join us.

WHAT WE ARE COLLECTING

We welcome non-perishable, unexpired food items. Items most needed:

Protein: Canned fish (tuna, salmon, sardines), canned chicken, dried or canned beans and lentils, peanut butter

Grains: Rolled oats, brown rice, whole wheat pasta, crackers

Fruits and vegetables: Canned tomatoes, canned corn, canned green beans, applesauce (no sugar added)

Soups and broths: Low-sodium chicken or vegetable broth, hearty soups

Breakfast: Oatmeal packets, cream of wheat, granola (low sugar)

Seasonal and special: Cranberry sauce, pumpkin puree, evaporated milk (for holiday cooking)

Personal care and baby items: Soap, toothpaste, diapers (size 2 and 3) -- often in short supply

Please check expiration dates. Items expiring before January 1, 2027 cannot be accepted.

DROP-OFF INFORMATION

Collection begins: Sunday, October 18, 2026

Collection closes: Sunday, November 15, 2026

Drop-off locations:

Grace Episcopal Church, main entrance foyer

Hours: Sundays 9 AM to 12 PM; Mondays and Thursdays 10 AM to 2 PM (office hours)

Hannaford Supermarket, Brighton Avenue, Portland (courtesy barrel at entrance)

Portland Public Library, Congress Street (lobby collection box through November 10)

For home pickup (for those unable to carry donations): Please call the church office at (207) 555-0238 or contact Joanne Lawton at (207) 555-0134. We will arrange a volunteer to collect from your door.

DISTRIBUTION

Donated items will be distributed through the following:

Thanksgiving Basket Program: Complete Thanksgiving meal baskets assembled and delivered to homebound parishioners and referred community families by November 25, 2026.

Ongoing Food Pantry: Surplus items held for distribution through December and into the new year.

Community Partner Organizations: Items not immediately needed will be shared with the Preble Street Resource Center and other partner food programs in Portland.

LAST YEAR'S RESULTS

Thanks to your generosity in 2025, Grace Episcopal collected 847 pounds of food and 43 hygiene items, assembled 22 Thanksgiving baskets, and partnered with two local soup kitchens for additional distribution. This year we are hoping to exceed 1,000 pounds.

A WORD FROM OUR ORGANIZER

We have been doing this drive together for longer than most of us care to count, and it still matters. Every basket we deliver to a homebound neighbor, every family who has a full Thanksgiving table because of what you brought in, is the reason we keep showing up.

Please bring what you can. Tell your neighbors. And if you would like to volunteer for sorting, packing, or delivery, call me and I will find you a job.

With gratitude and in faith,

Joanne Lawton

Food Drive Coordinator, Grace Episcopal Outreach Committee

(207) 555-0134

joanne.lawton@Greenridertech.co

VOLUNTEERS NEEDED

Saturday, November 14, 2026: Sorting and packing day at the church, 9 AM to 1 PM

Saturday, November 22, 2026: Delivery day for homebound baskets, 10 AM to 2 PM

Drivers with vehicles: Please contact Joanne or David Mitchell at (207) 555-0178

Thank you. God bless you and your household.